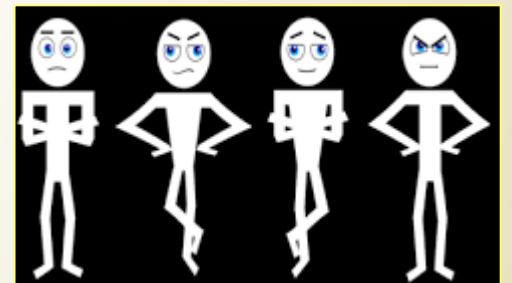


# Developing Soft Skills and Personality

Week 7  
Module 1  
Lecture 37

*Dr. T. Ravichandran*  
*Professor of English*  
*Department of Humanities and Social Sciences*  
*The Indian Institute of Technology, Kanpur, India*

Non-Verbal  
Communication



Introduction and Importance

# Highlights



## Highlights of the Last Lecture



### Non-Verbal Communication:

2<sup>nd</sup> Pre-Thinking Assessment for checking your existing knowledge about body language and to clear certain misconceptions about non-verbal communication.

### All 10 True Statements:

1. Silence can be used as a powerful means of dominance.
2. Non-verbal communication can contradict verbal meaning.
3. Non-verbal communication can be used as a substitute for verbal communication.
4. Some non-verbal signs are universal and commonly acceptable.
5. Gestures, which indicate similar verbal meaning, can differ non-verbally according to their cultural backgrounds.
6. The face is the most powerful channel of non-verbal communication.
7. We move away from persons we dislike.
8. Negative non-verbal signals are more noticeable than the positive ones.
9. Awareness of your body language can help you control it.
10. It is difficult to fake body language for a long period of time.

**Accessories can enhance the effectiveness of communication as well as act as barriers**

High-heels help maintaining eye-contact. The females do not have to look up to the male bosses! *But a diamond studded high-heels is a distracter!*

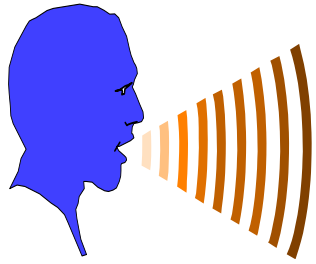
Any inappropriate accessory can cause barrier!

Clothing, body perfume, watch, ear rings, make-up, dying of hair, etc.

# Importance of Body Language

*"What you do speaks so  
loud  
that I cannot hear  
what you say."*

*- Ralph*



# What Is Non-Verbal Communication?

**Communication without words.**

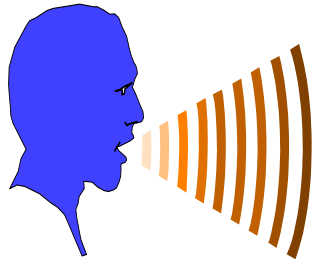
**Communication using images, symbols, signs, gestures, facial expressions, postures, etc.**



**e.g., A smile, a frown, can communicate and convey message without words**

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# What is Non-Verbal Communication?

- A dynamic and continuous communication process where commonly understood codes are used by the senders and the receivers .

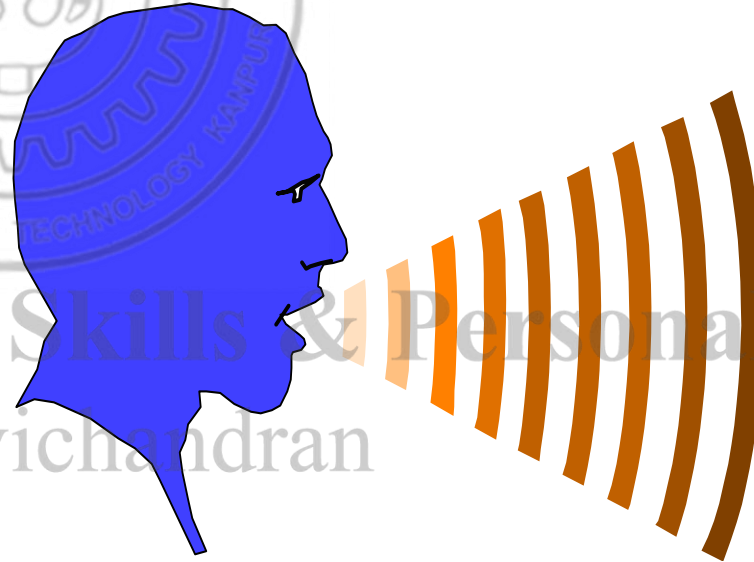


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# What Is Communication?

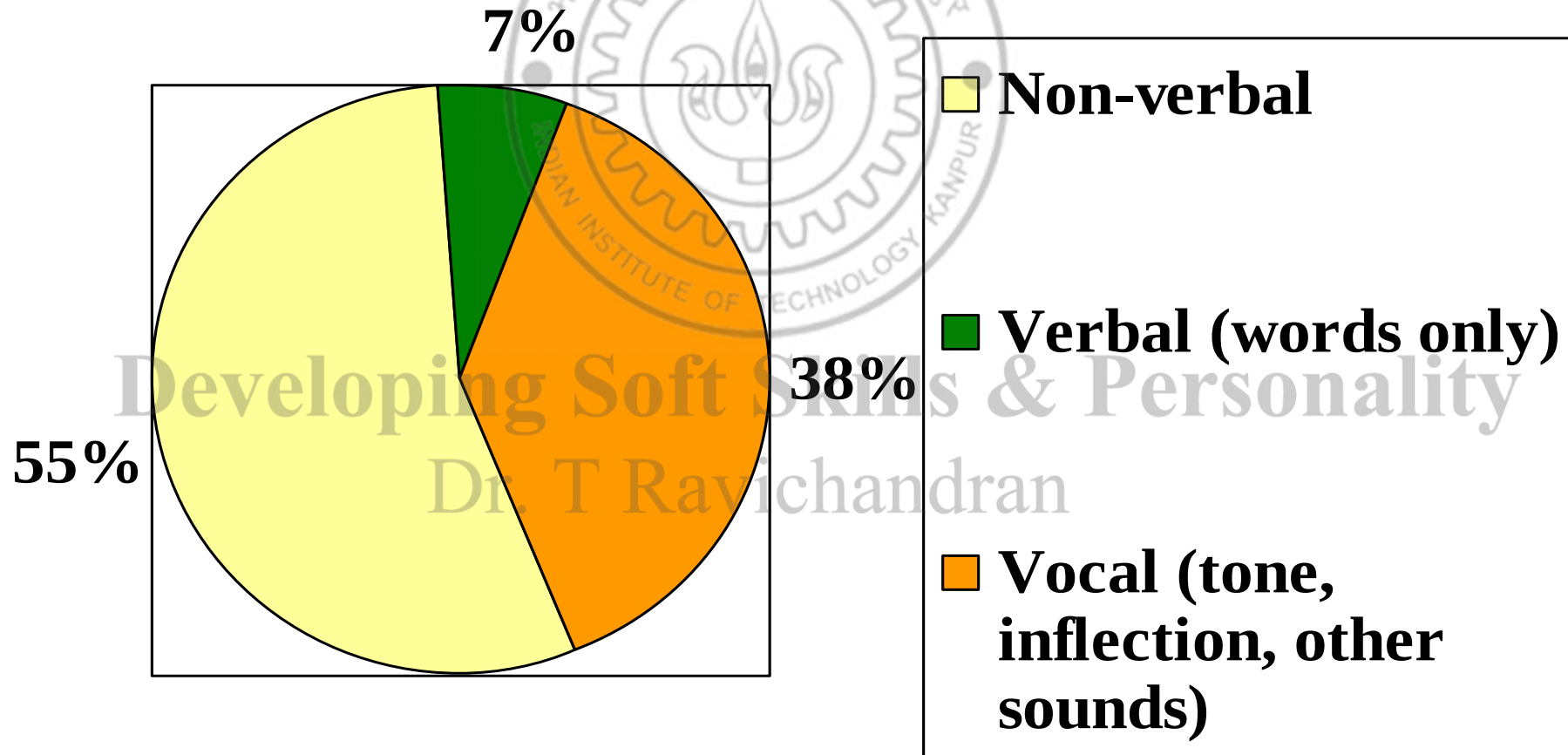
- **93% Body Language**
- **7% Words**

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# Most communication is *NONVERBAL*

(Albert Mehrabian, *Silent Messages: Implicit Communication of Emotions and Attitudes*, 1971;  
*Nonverbal Communication*, 1972)



# Why do we study nonverbal communication?

## *The Importance of Nonverbal Messages*

- ✓ **Nonverbal messages communicate emotions**

**Nonverbal messages are harder to hide and consciously control, so they are more accurate indicators of how a person feels.**

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**In communication, you can always stop the verbal; but NEVER the nonverbal!**



Nonverbal Communication is strongly related to verbal communication

## **Functions of Nonverbal Communication** (Ekman & Friesen, 1969)

- ✓ **Repeat what is said verbally**
- ✓ **Complement or clarify verbal meaning**
- ✓ **Contradict verbal meaning**
- ✓ **Regulate verbal interaction**
- ✓ **Substitute for verbal meaning**

# Nature or Nurture?

The genetics debate: heredity, innate

Things like the narrowing of the eyes is universal and natural

The Japanese comic (*manga*);  
the heroes are wide-eyed and innocent,  
the bad guys are always shown with  
narrowed eyes!



# Nature or Nurture?

## The genetics debate



**Use of territory**



**Safeguarding of private space**



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# Nature or Nurture?



✿ Nurture:

NVC is learnt.

Desired behaviour can be cultivated.



Anthropologists and Sociologists like Hall and Goffman



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# Just Functional?

**Functional:**

Non-Verbal Communication is used to fulfill communication functions.

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Psychologists and Communication Theorists  
Like Mehrabian and E. T. Hall







**“Of all the things you wear,  
your expression is the most important.”**

**— Janet Lane**

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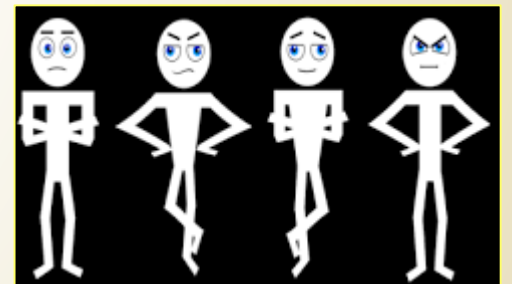
# Developing Soft Skills and Personality



Week 7  
Module 2  
Lecture 38

*Dr. T. Ravichandran*  
*Professor of English*  
*Department of Humanities and Social Sciences*  
*The Indian Institute of Technology, Kanpur, India*

Non-Verbal  
Communication



Issues and Types

# Highlights



## Highlights of the Last Lecture



### The Importance of Non-Verbal Communication:

Non-Verbal Communication is Communication without words. Communication using images, symbols, signs, gestures, facial expressions, postures, etc.

Body language speaks louder than the verbal language

93% of Communication effectiveness is determined by body language

Nonverbal messages communicate emotions.

Nonverbal messages are harder to hide and consciously control, so they are more accurate indicators of how a person feels.

### Functions of Nonverbal Communication

- ✓ Repeat what is said verbally
- ✓ Complement or clarify verbal meaning
- ✓ Contradict verbal meaning
- ✓ Regulate verbal interaction
- ✓ Substitute for verbal meaning

Nature or Nurture?

Nurture: Desired behaviour can be learnt and cultivated.





# Voluntary Body Language

**Refers to movement, gestures and poses intentionally made by the person:  
smiling, shaking hands, imitating actions.**



**Realization of what is being communicated.**

**Less commonly discussed because it seems unproblematic.**

**It can apply to many types of soundless communication, for example, formalized gestures.**

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## Involuntary Body Language



- Involuntary movements that may give observers cues about what one is really thinking or feeling.
- Ability to interpret such movements may itself be unconscious, at least for untrained observers.
- Involuntary body language is the most accurate way into a person's subconscious.
- Interrogators, customs examiners, and others who have to seek information that people do not necessarily want to give have always relied on explicit or implicit hypotheses about body language.

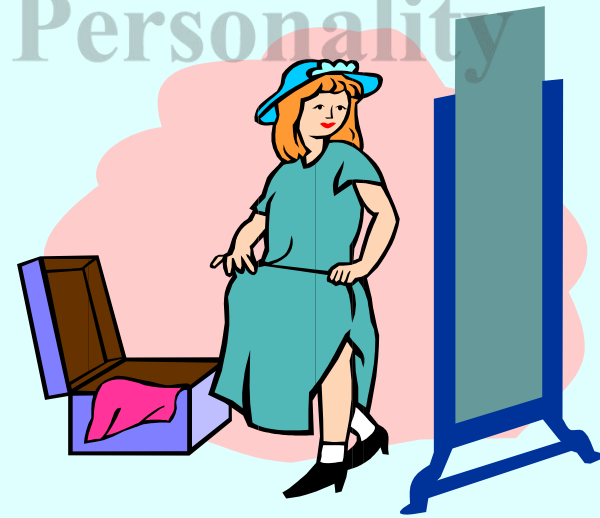
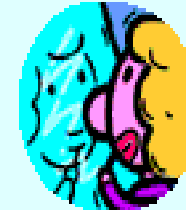


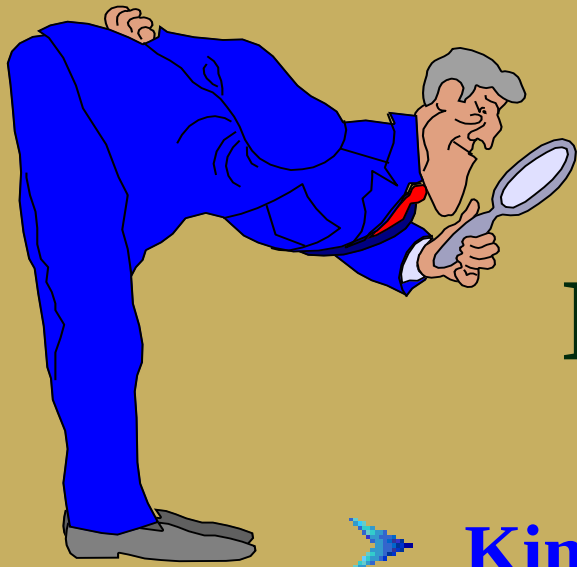


# Appearance



- Appearance conveys non-verbal impressions that affect receivers' attitudes towards the verbal messages even before they hear the message.
- Clothing, hair style, neatness, cosmetics, etc., are part of personal appearance.
- People who are attractive are judged to be more intelligent, more capable, and more desirable than others are.
- No factual basis—but it can affect decisions about, hiring, placement and promotion.





# Types of Nonverbal Communication

- **Kinesics** - body movement and gesture
- **Facial Expression**
- **Oculesics** - eye gaze
- **Haptics** - touch
- **Proxemics** - use of interpersonal space
- **Chronemics** - time
- **Paralinguistics** - vocal cues and silence



# KINESICS: Part/Whole Body Movement

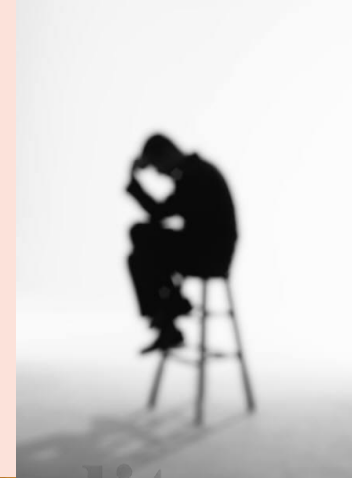
**“Science” of kinesthetics, or “body language” can be very revealing.**

**Watching people’s actions can bring you a lot closer to the truth than merely listening to what they say (which might be a cover-up).**

**Outward expressions of inner feelings.**

# Postures

- Posture refers to the position in which you hold your body when standing or sitting
- Postures convey impressions of self-confidence, status and interest.







# What is Gesture?

**A movement of a limb or the body  
as an expression of  
thought or feeling.**

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*--Oxford Concise Dictionary 1995*

# Gesture

**Gestures have cultural background. They are learnt within the society & culture to which one belongs.**

**Gestures either accompany spoken language or stand alone in conveying a particular message.**

**e.g., pointing on a place on map while speaking about a site**



# The Face

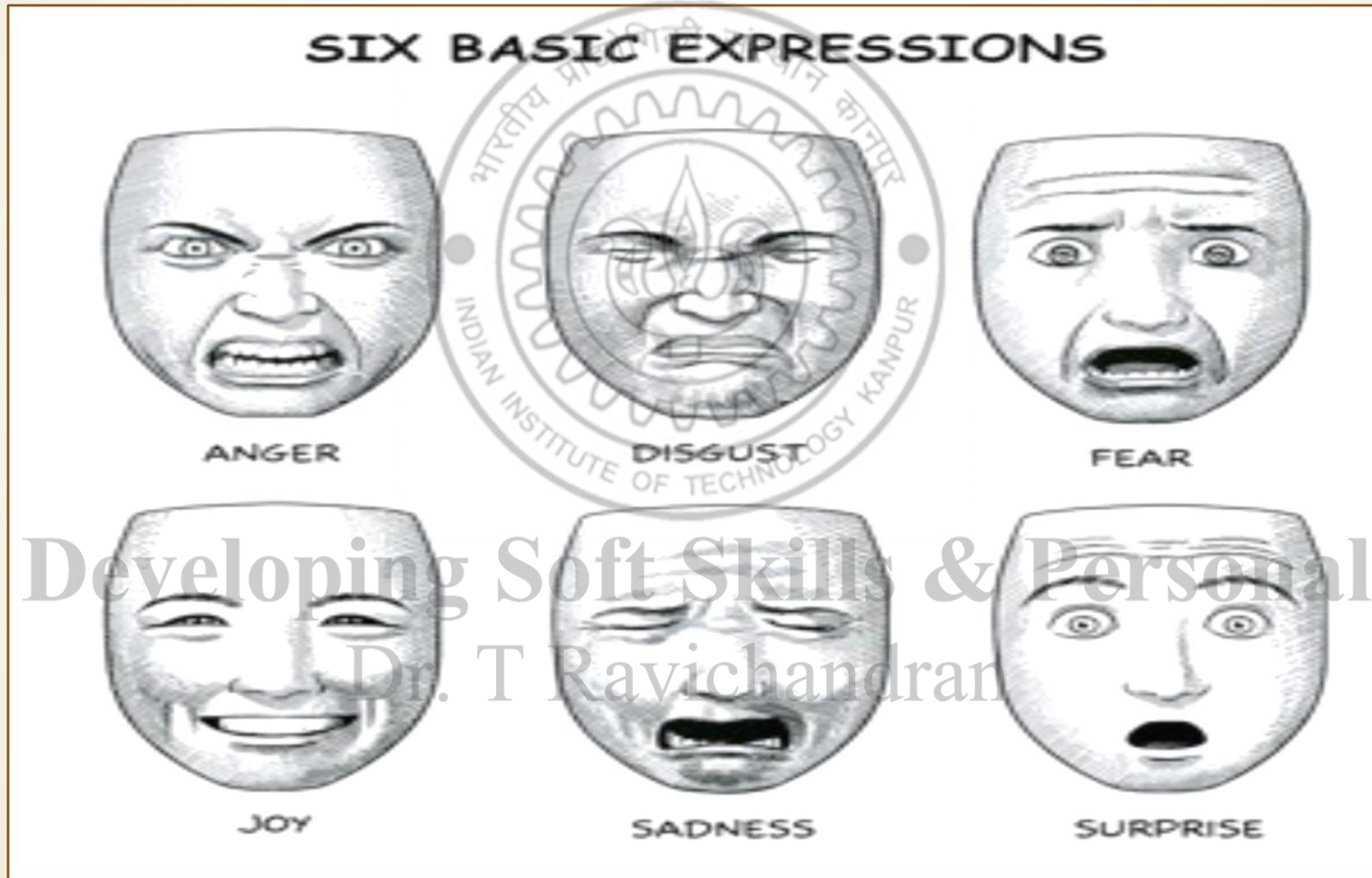


- The most powerful ‘channel’ of NVC
- We indulge in an “encoding”/“decoding” process while using facial expressions for communication.
- Even in the most simple interaction, we focus on face.
- Face gives clues to: attraction, interest in relationship, display of emotions, identity, background, age, humor, and sub-texts.

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# Six Basic Facial Expressions





# Eyes: Do they tell the same story?



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# OCULESICS:

## Gaze & Eye Contact

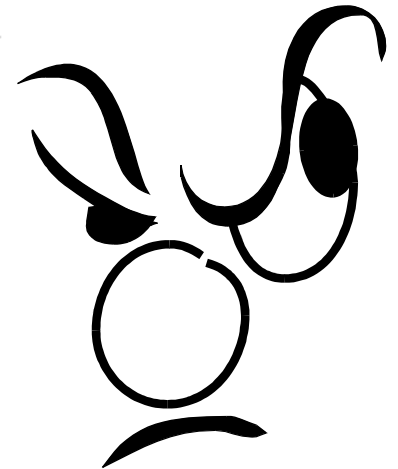
- **Gaze** is the term used to mean looking at a person
- **Eye-contact** means mutual gaze, where the two look at each other at the same time
- Maintaining eye contact signals genuineness
- Avoiding it signals shiftiness



# OCULESICS: Gaze & Eye Contact

- Americans are taught to look directly.
- Japanese and Koreans are taught to avoid direct eye contact, direct eye contact to them is considered a weakness, and may indicate sexual overtones!

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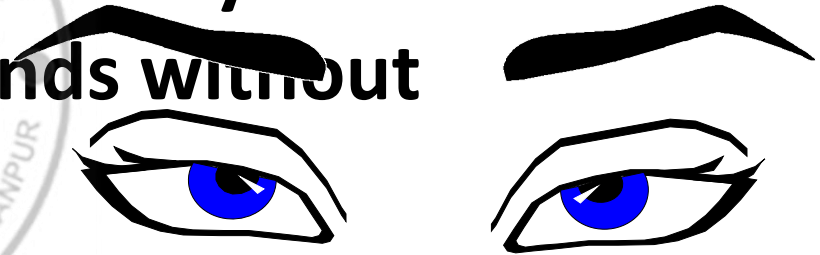




# OCULESICS:

## Gaze & Eye Contact

- Shy and timid people cannot hold eye contact for more than just a few seconds without glancing away.
- It does not imply that s/he is lying, but that s/he is merely intimidated by the presence of the person with whom they are speaking.

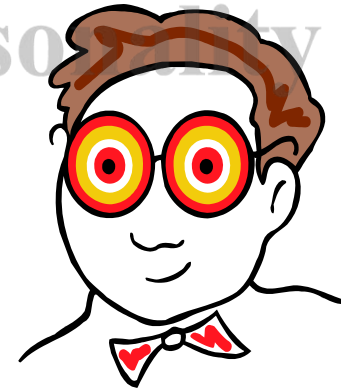




# EYE CONTACT: Voluntary Dimensions

- ***Voluntary Dimension:***  
**Friendliness, respect, interest, comfort, even domination**
- **Duration/frequency/not meeting—*means something***

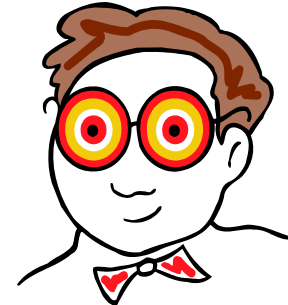
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# EYE CONTACT: Voluntary Dimensions

*We avoid eye contact with strangers—*

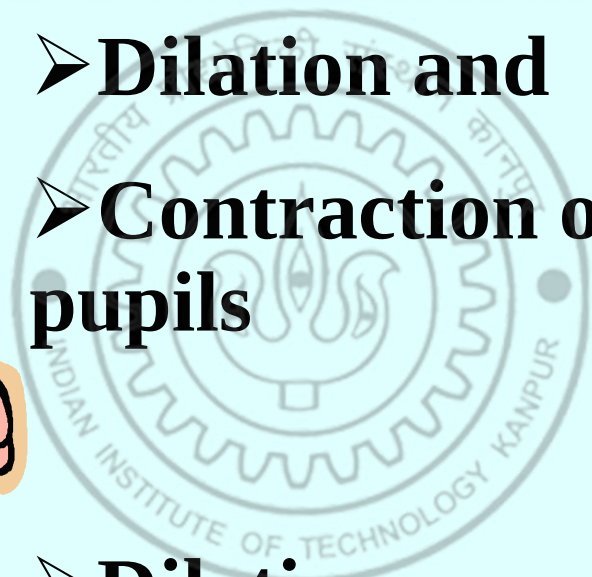
- Even in physically close situations (as in a lift)
- With known; it implies lack of interest
- Children are sensitive towards eye contact
- It is uninteresting to listen without eyes meeting— News Readers
- Good Speakers—manage to give the feel of looking at all of the audience.



# EYE CONTACT:

## Involuntary Dimensions

- Dilation and
- Contraction of pupils
- Dilation: objects of interest

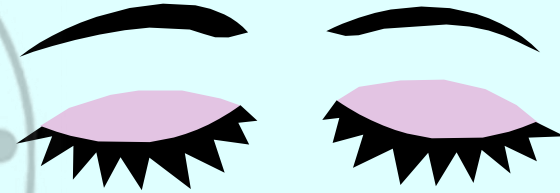


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# **EYE CONTACT: Involuntary Dimensions**

➤ **Contraction:  
boredom**

➤ **Smart people-manipulative sellers-  
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measure customer preferences;  
use it to attract and retain clients**

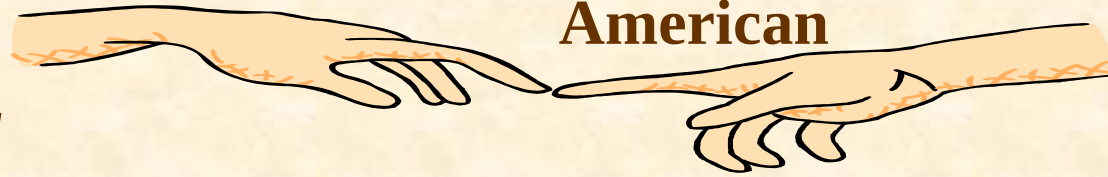




# HAPTICS: Touch

## Use of physical contact when communicating

- ✓ One of the very first non-verbal symbols a new-born baby is lovingly exposed to—continues as major means
  - *In India:* men walking hand in hand shows friendship
  - Europe:* homo-sexuals
- ✓ Meanings are imposed by culture
  - e.g., A Male Guest visiting the lady of the house—
    - *In India:* Touching the feet of elders—normal to show respect
  - *Latin American:* hugs
  - *European:* Shakes/kisses her hand
  - *Indian:* Namaste
  - *Arab:* Not even sees her
  - America:* appears to be slavish & embarrasses an American





# HAPTICS: Human Touch



**Touching is the first form of communication by infants**

**Development as a healthy adult depends on the amount of touch received as an infant**



**Touch is used to comfort a crying baby**



- **Touch is also used to comfort an adult**



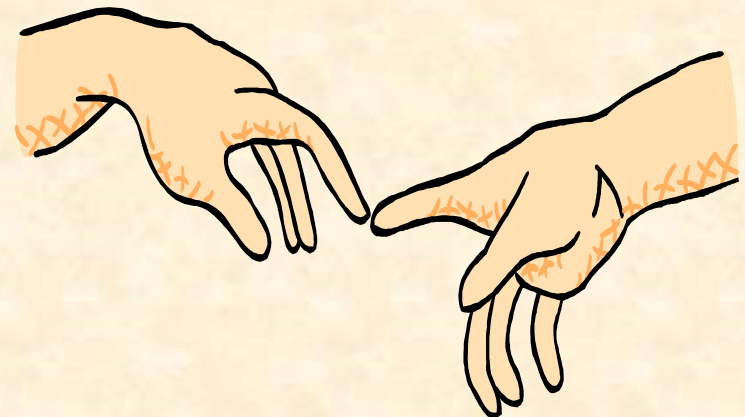
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# HAPTICS – Professional touch

**Americans use a firm, solid grip**

**Middle Easterners and Orientals prefer a gentle grip – a firm grip to them suggests unnecessary aggressiveness**

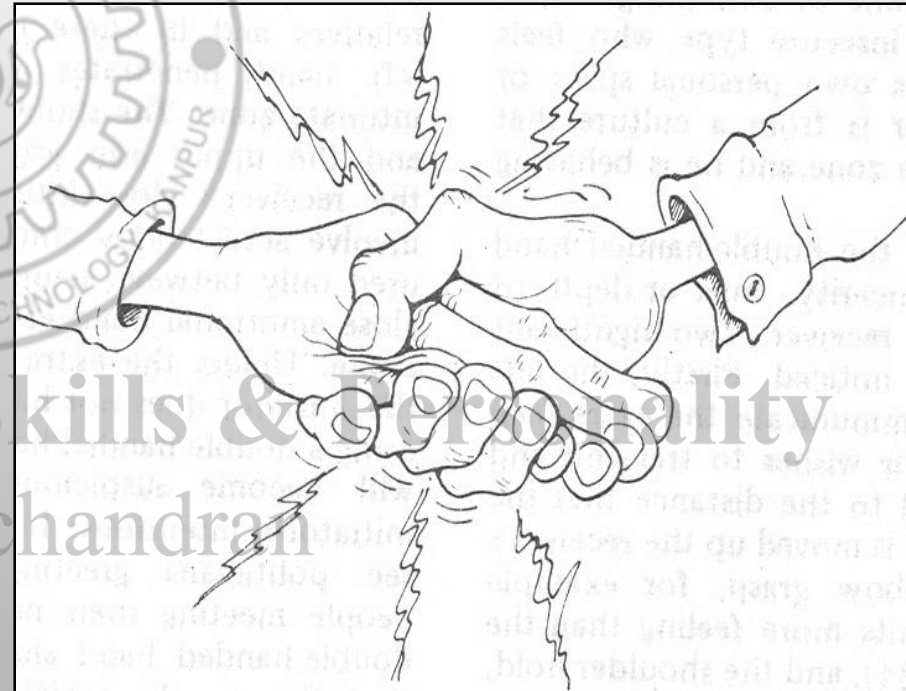




# Neither the deadfish nor the knuckle grinder...



Dead Fish Handshake



Developo

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But a Firm  
Handshake!



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# PROXEMICS: Use of Space, Distance & Proximity



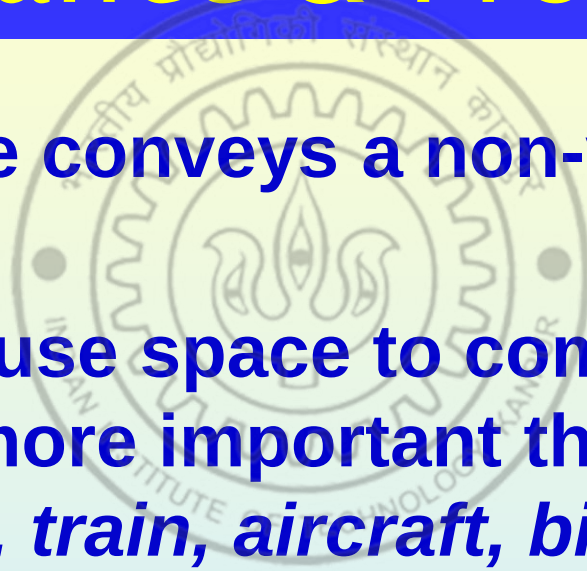
**The distance conveys a non-verbal message.**



**The way we use space to communicate: the richer, the more important the greater the space—e.g., *train, aircraft, bigger houses***



**Familiarity breeds contempt—get respect by more space**



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# PROXEMICS: Extent of space



## Importance/degree of formality

e.g. taking back seat in taxi

The bigger the leader, the larger the area sealed;  
greater the honour when they come near/shake hands

Sitting on a park bench; leaving space for strangers



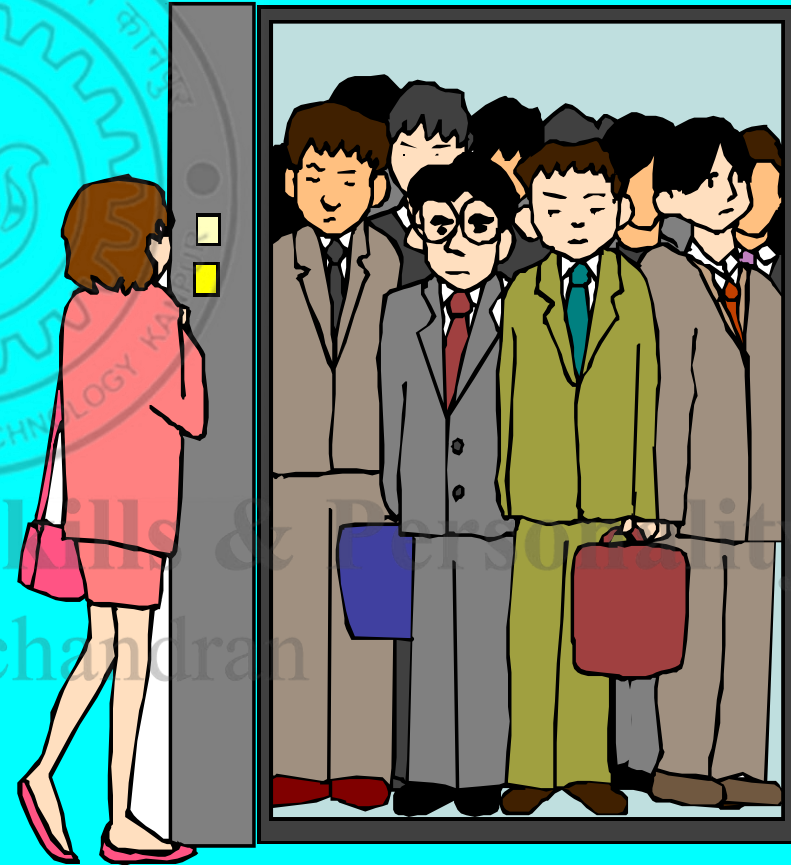
When Physical space is not available, we  
create Psychological space

An overcrowded lift—tighten our muscles, shrink  
ourselves

# Different Cultures ...

- ❑ A crowded culture

- ❑ What is your private space?



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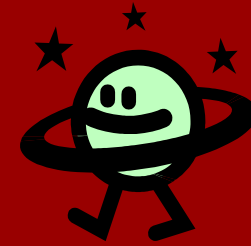
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# Territory

## 4 Types of Interpersonal Distance



### Intimate

- Touching
- 6-18" inches

### Personal

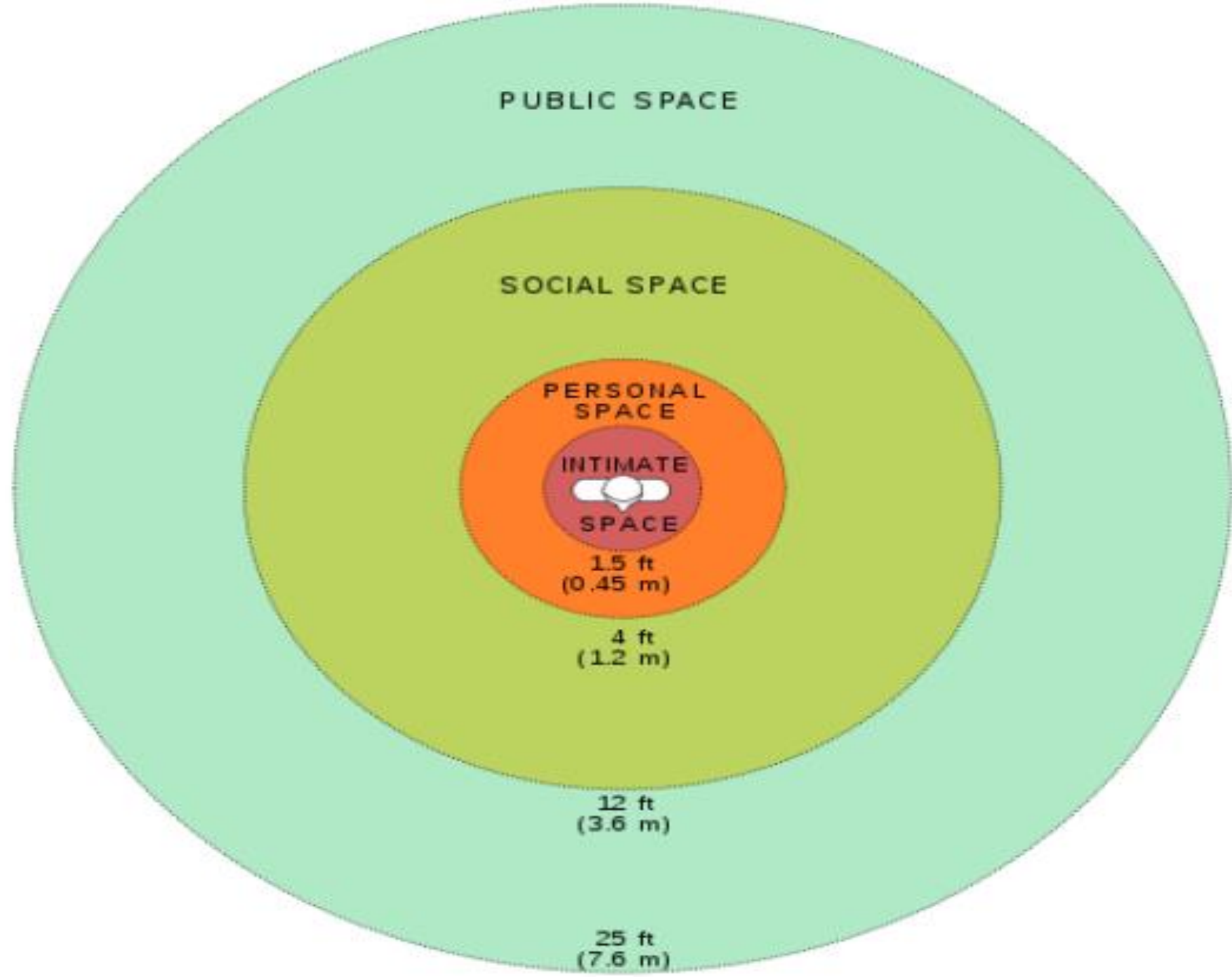
- Close -  $1\frac{1}{2}$  to  $2\frac{1}{2}$  feet
- Far -  $2\frac{1}{2}$  to  $4\frac{1}{2}$  feet

### Social

- Close 4-7 feet
- Far - 7-12 feet

### Public

- Close - 12-25 feet
- Far - 25 feet or greater



# When you invade my space

- Reactions to an invasion of your space

- Feel troubled
- Get defensive
- Become aggressive
- Retaliate



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# When you invade my space

- **Reactions to an invasion of your space**

- **Avoid conversation**

- **Avoid eye contact**

- **Place objects in between**

- **Focus attention elsewhere**





# CHRONEMICS: Time Perception

- **Arriving late** is a way of showing importance
- **Time Taken for an event is symbolic**  
More time with people and projects that interests more (interviews)
- **Time Taken to respond is symbolic**  
boss approving requests
- **The Timing of an Event** can have symbolic overtones

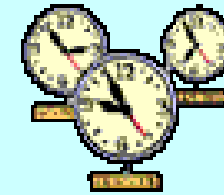


# CHRONEMICS: Time Perception



## **Monochronic perspective:**

time is a scarce resource,  
which must be rationed and controlled.



## **Polychronic perspective:**

time is flexible, used for the  
maintenance of harmonious  
relationships.



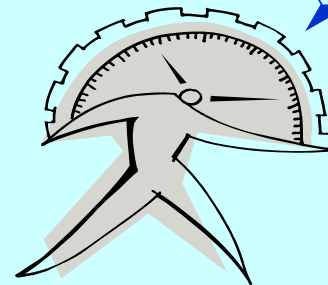
# CHRONEMICS: Time Perception



➤ Americans use M time:

➤ *monochronic time* emphasizes schedules, appointments, segmentation, and promptness

➤ Do one thing at a time, concentrate on the job



➤ Middle East & Latin America use P time:

➤ *polychronic time* characterized by several things going on at once

➤ Highly distractible

➤ Consider time commitments casually

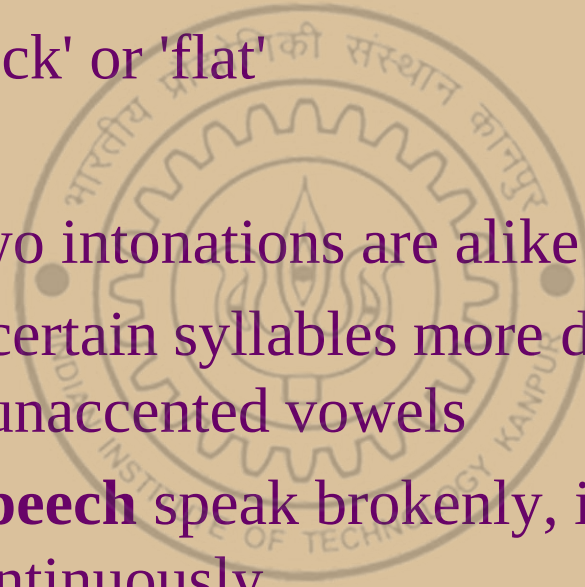


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# What is Paralanguage or Metacommunication?

- **Voice** - 'vibrant', 'thick' or 'flat'
- **Voice Dynamics**
  - **Intonation** no two intonations are alike
  - **Rhythm** accent certain syllables more definitely, lengthen more vowels, shorten unaccented vowels
  - **Continuity of Speech** speak brokenly, in uneasy splashes of word groups, speak continuously
  - **Speed of Speech** speak above or below certain socialized speeds
- **Pronunciation**
- **Vocabulary** Personality reflected in choice of words
- **Style**



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# Silence

Silence is a lack of communicated sound.

Although quiet, it can communicate powerful messages.

**“I am not speaking to you” speaks volumes.**

**Conveys different meanings—**

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**contentment**

**embarrassment**

**punishment**

# On Silence . . .

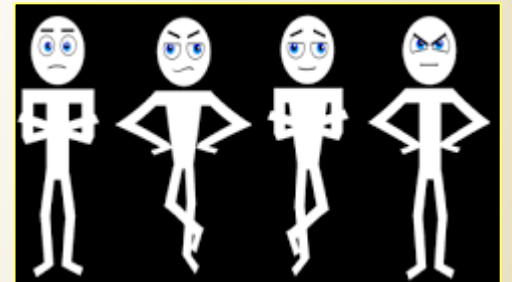
- **Speech is silver, but silence is golden . . .**
  - **If you can not understand my silence,  
you can not understand my words!**
  - **“Never say anything that doesn’t improve on silence.”**
- Dr. T Ravichandran **— Richard Yates**

# Developing Soft Skills and Personality

Week 7  
Module 3  
Lecture 39

Non-Verbal  
Communication

*Dr. T. Ravichandran*  
*Professor of English*  
*Department of Humanities and Social Sciences*  
*The Indian Institute of Technology, Kanpur, India*



Basics and Universals

# Highlights



## Highlights of the Last Lecture



### Issues of Non-Verbal Communication:

Voluntary body language: formalised gestures, unproblematic

Involuntary body language: subconscious reflections, problematic

### Issues with Appearance:

People who are attractive are judged to be more intelligent.

No factual basis—but it can affect decisions about, hiring, placement and promotion.

### Types of Nonverbal Communication

Kinesics--body movement and gesture

Facial Expression

Oculesics--eye gaze

Haptics--touch

Proxemics--use of interpersonal space

Chronemics--time

Paralinguistics--vocal cues and silence



# Body Language: Basics and Universals

- Some gestures have culturally different meaning.
- Yet, there are some universally acceptable expressions.
- Most of them have originated from the Western concepts.
- While applying them, especially, in an Indian context, we need to use our discretion!
- **Example: Touching the feet of elders**
- **Western: Slavish, trying to flatter, not honest, uncultured**
- **Indian: Respectful, sincere, well-behaved, cultured**

# Basics



## Defensive Gesture:

Crossing arms (slightly slouched) and legs while standing indicates **insecurity, lack of interest in mingling with others, lack of trust in the other person, internal discomfort**

➤ However, if you are seated this can mean empathy/sympathy.



# Basics

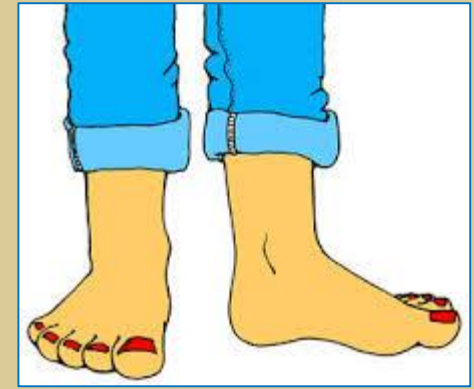
## Offensive Gesture?

Crossing arms (upright and tight) and legs (firm/open) while standing indicates **self-confidence, contentment, modesty, humility, etc.**  
**extreme case—arrogance!**

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# Basics



## Attraction: Feet

➤ If you are standing or sitting and are attracted to someone (whether or not you are talking to them) your feet will be pointing in their direction!

## Dislike: Feet

If you approach 2 people talking: If the feet of the people stay in place and they twist only their upper torsos in your direction, they dislike your joining.



# Basics & Universals

## Attraction

➤ **Men: Occasionally play with one of their ear lobes.**

**Women: will play with a lock of hair or continually tuck their hair behind their ears.**

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➤ **Men digging ear wax from their ears; picking nose, especially while communicating with women, are filthy or perverted.**

# Basics & Universals

- **Openness:** Open hands, unbuttoned coat.
- **Defensiveness:** Arms crossed, sideways glance, touching/rubbing nose, rubbing eyes, buttoned coat, drawing away.
- **Insecurity:** Pinching flesh, chewing pen, thumb over thumb, biting fingernail.
- **Cooperation:** Upper body in sprinter's position, open hands, sitting on edge of chair, hand to face gestures, unbuttoning coat.

# Basics & Universals

- **Confidence:** Steepled hands, hands behind back, back stiffened, hands in coat pockets with thumb out, hands on lapels of coat.
- **Nervousness:** Clearing throat, whistling, smoking, pinching flesh, fidgeting, covering mouth, jiggling money or keys, tugging ears, wringing hands.
- **Frustration:** Short breaths, "tsk" sound, tightly clenched hands, wringing hands, fist-like gestures, rubbing hand through hair, rubbing back of neck.

| <b>NONVERBAL<br/>BEHAVIOR</b>             | <b>INTERPRETATION</b>                |
|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <b>Tilted head</b>                        | <b>Interest</b>                      |
| <b>Stroking chin</b>                      | <b>Trying to make a<br/>decision</b> |
| <b>Looking down, face<br/>turned away</b> | <b>Disbelief</b>                     |
| <b>Biting nails</b>                       | <b>Insecurity,<br/>nervousness</b>   |
| <b>Rubbing hands</b>                      | <b>Anticipation</b>                  |
| <b>Pulling or tugging<br/>at ear</b>      | <b>Indecision</b>                    |



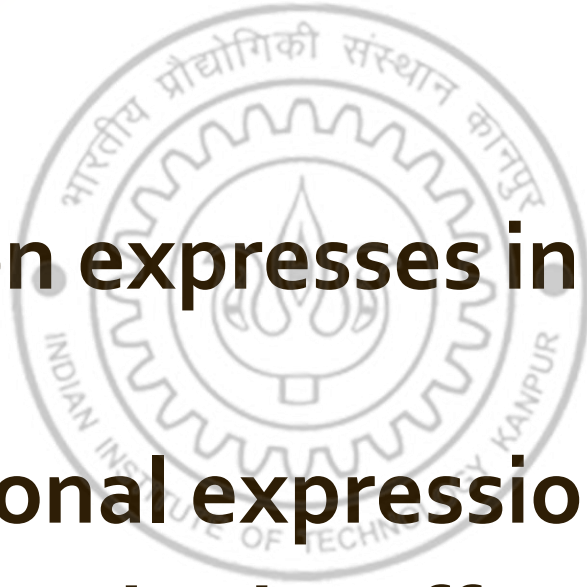
| <b>NONVERBAL<br/>BEHAVIOR</b>                               | <b>INTERPRETATION</b>                       |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| <b>Hand to cheek</b>                                        | <b>Evaluation, thinking</b>                 |
| <b>Touching, slightly<br/>rubbing nose</b>                  | <b>Rejection, doubt,<br/>lying</b>          |
| <b>Rubbing the eye</b>                                      | <b>Doubt, disbelief</b>                     |
| <b>Hands clasped<br/>behind back</b>                        | <b>Anger, frustration,<br/>apprehension</b> |
| <b>Locked ankles</b>                                        | <b>Apprehension</b>                         |
| <b>Inspecting<br/>fingernails or looking<br/>at a watch</b> | <b>Boredom, Vanity</b>                      |
| <b>Head resting in hand,<br/>eyes downcast</b>              | <b>Boredom</b>                              |

| <b>NONVERBAL<br/>BEHAVIOR</b>                                   | <b>INTERPRETATION</b>                  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| <b>Brisk, erect walk</b>                                        | <b>Confidence</b>                      |
| <b>Standing with hands<br/>on hips</b>                          | <b>Readiness, aggression</b>           |
| <b>Sitting with legs<br/>crossed, foot kicking<br/>slightly</b> | <b>Boredom</b>                         |
| <b>Sitting, legs apart<br/>Arms crossed on<br/>chest</b>        | <b>Open, relaxed<br/>Defensiveness</b> |
| <b>Walking with hands<br/>in pockets,<br/>shoulders hunched</b> | <b>Dejection</b>                       |

| <b>NONVERBAL BEHAVIOR</b>                                   | <b>INTERPRETATION</b>                      |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sitting with hands clasped behind head, legs crossed</b> | <b>Confidence, superiority</b>             |
| <b>Open palm</b>                                            | <b>Sincerity, openness, innocence</b>      |
| <b>Pinching bridge of nose, eyes closed</b>                 | <b>Negative evaluation</b>                 |
| <b>Tapping or drumming fingers</b>                          | <b>Impatience</b>                          |
| <b>Steepling fingers</b>                                    | <b>Authoritative</b>                       |
| <b>Patting/fondling/rubbing hair</b>                        | <b>Lack of self-confidence; insecurity</b> |

# Body Language . . .

- **Innate in us.**
- **Even a blind person expresses in body language effectively!**
- **Most of the emotional expressions lie latent in us.**
- **You have to work and take efforts to make them manifested!**
- **Use body language to better your life and achieve what you want!**



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**“The body never lies.” ~ Martha Graham**



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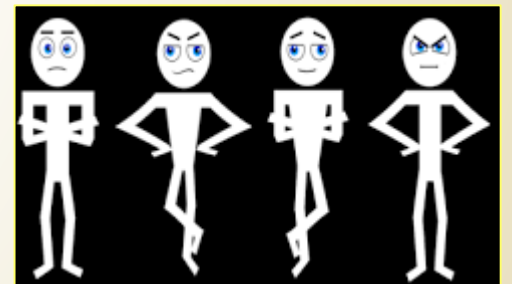
# Developing Soft Skills and Personality



**Week 7**  
**Module 4**  
**Lecture 40**

*Dr. T. Ravichandran*  
*Professor of English*  
*Department of Humanities and Social Sciences*  
*The Indian Institute of Technology, Kanpur, India*

**Non-Verbal  
Communication**



**Interpreting Non-Verbal Cues**

# Highlights



## Highlights of the Last Lecture



### Body Language: Basics and Universals:

We should use caution while applying some basic and universal body language in the Indian context.

Defensive Gesture like crossing arms can also be interpreted as offensive gesture depending on the way one crosses the arms!

Feet: Can be indicators of attraction, withdrawal/dislike

More basics and universals indicating

Openness

Defensiveness

Insecurity

Cooperation

Confidence

Nervousness

Frustration, etc.

Body language is innate. What is latent in us can be manifested by good efforts and practice.

# Interpreting Non-verbal Cues

- **Albert Mehrabian in *Silent Messages* (1971) identified three primary dimensions**
- **Immediacy cues communicate **liking and pleasure****

We move toward persons and things we like and avoid or move away from those we dislike. Generally, we instinctively decide whether we like someone or not and then later find 'reasons' to back up our feelings.
- **Arousal (not sexual) similar to animation. **Responsiveness.****

Interested in a person—we tend to be more animated. A flat tone of voice and very little movement indicate a lack of interest.
- **Dominance **balance of power**; information about status, position**

High-status people—relaxed body posture



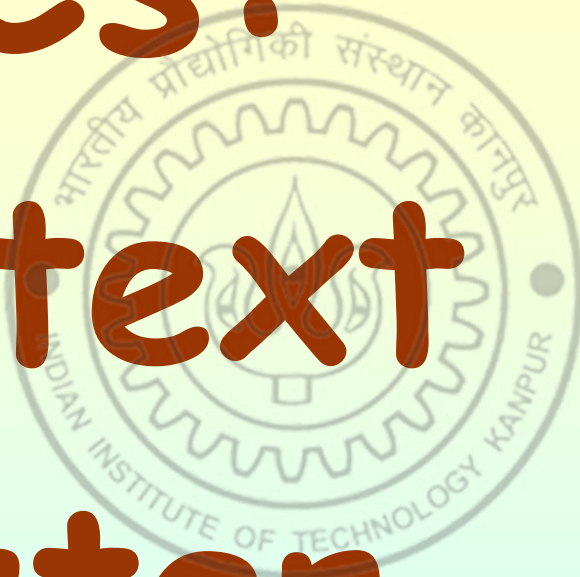
# Interpreting Non-Verbal Cues: 3 Cs

## 3 Cs:

➤ Context

➤ Cluster

➤ Change



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# Becoming a Non-verbalist: How to identify a liar?

- ✓ **Sweating , Biting of fingernails , Chewing of the inside of the mouth**
- ✓ **Drying up of the mouth, Covering the mouth**
- ✓ **Rubbing the nose continuously**



- **This is if they are bad liars, or they are lying to someone that knows them well!**
- **Some people are excellent liars, and can mask all of the above.**

# Becoming a Non-verbalist: How to identify a liar?

- **Professional liars have refined their body gestures!**
- ✓ **Observe combinations of behaviours that a person is displaying.**
- **The ability to tell whether someone is lying depends on many factors that must be observed, rather than just one factor that can completely mislead you.**
- ✓ **Differences in behaviour from their 'normal' behaviour**
- ✓ **Variation in the normal eye contact duration**
- ✓ **Tendency to look up (to cook up something!)**
- ✓ **Hand gestures/lack of gestures**
- **Police interrogators: suspect's body in full view**
- **The best way to lie is over the telephone!**



# Challenges of Studying NVC

## 1) Nonverbal Messages Are Often Ambiguous

Nonverbal message may be known only to the person displaying them. Some people have difficulty expressing their emotions nonverbally, i.e, frozen facial expression, someone who is feeling happy may not necessarily smile.

## 2) Nonverbal Messages Are Continuous

Gestures, facial expressions and eye contact can flow from one situation to the next. It is possible to stop talking, but it is generally not possible to stop nonverbal cues.



# Challenges of Studying NVC

## 3) Nonverbal Cues are Multi-Channeled

**Can attend to only one nonverbal cue at a time.  
One researcher believes negative nonverbal  
command attention before positive nonverbal  
messages!**

## 4) Nonverbal Interpretation is Culture Based

**Positive Gestures in one culture may be seen as  
obscene in another.**

**(thumbs-up gesture in the USA is positive; in Britain,  
Australia & New Zealand it is considered negative  
and can indicate abuse/insult).**



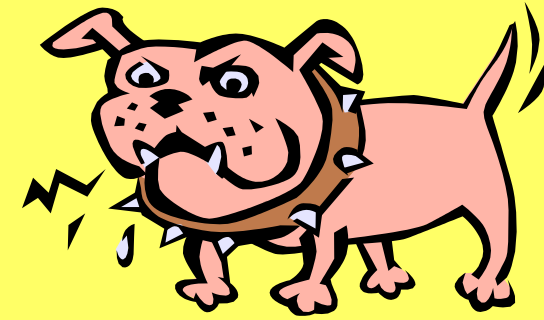
# Caution!!!

- **The main point is don't apply one piece of information as meaning everything.**
- **You must be observant of all the possible factors that may be contributing to the other person's movements, including things like temperature, climate and weather.**
- **Don't jump to conclusions, be aware of your surroundings and familiarize yourself with the other person's habits, gestures, signs and body language before making any assumptions.**

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# Aggression?!



- **At first glance, the pup appears to be showing aggression. However, when you look more closely you will see that the eyes are closed and that the ears are back.**
- **The pup is yawning!**

# Clothing and Appearance



- **Clothing and appearance as nonverbal communication tell who we are, our age, gender, status, socioeconomic class and race.**
- **Nonverbal communication is not an exact science, it is easy to make a bad or false first impression based on what you wear and how you look.**
- **All that glitters is not gold!**
- **Appearance is deceptive!**





# How do we Control our Body Language?

- **The best way to control body language is to be aware of it in the first place.**
- **Some people have extremely open body language and others have learned to control their emotions.**
- **The first trick an actor learns is how to express emotion with his body. Not just the face, but the whole body.**
- **Therefore it is possible to turn your back on someone and make them aware that you are angry or sad!**

# Competent Communicators

- **Are good at monitoring their nonverbal messages and messages from others.**
- **Develop a wide range of nonverbal behaviors to use in different situations.**

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# Why should we learn body language?

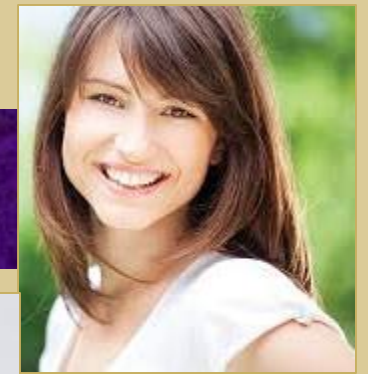
- **It is difficult to fake body language for a long period of time.**
- **It is good to learn and to use positive open gestures to communicate with others and to eliminate gestures that may give negative signals.**
- **You will feel more comfortable to be with people and can become more acceptable to them.**

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# Positive Body Language

- **Smile**
- **Open Posture**
- **Forward Lean**
- **Touch**
- **Eye Contact**
- **Gestures & Nods**



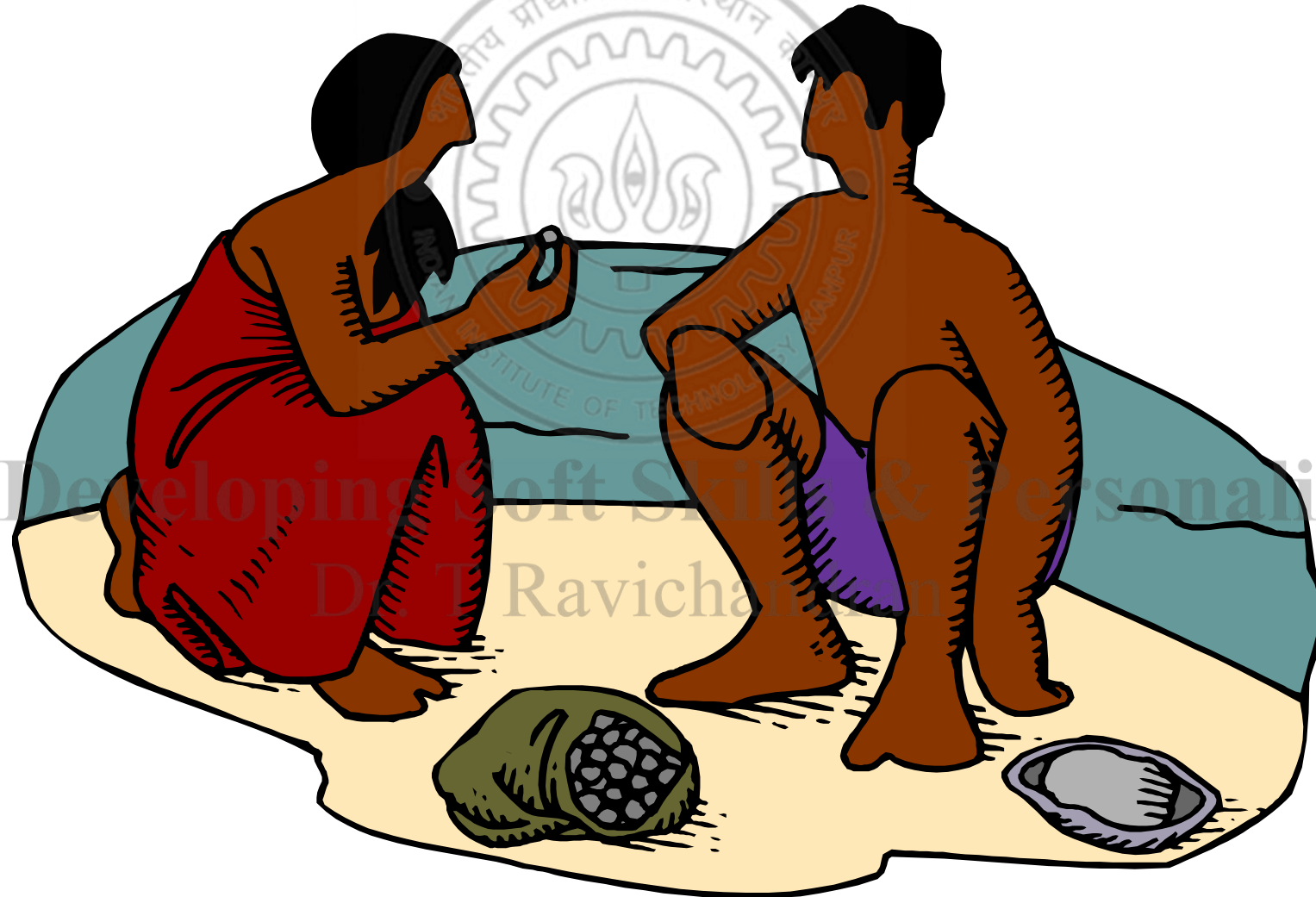
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Analyze this!  
Who is more interested?



Analyze this!  
Who is more interested?



# Developing Soft Skills and Personality



**Week 7**  
**Module 5**  
**Lecture 41**

**Body  
Language**

*Dr. T. Ravichandran*  
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**For Interviews**

# Highlights



## Highlights of the Last Lecture



### Interpreting Non-Verbal Cues:

3 Primary Dimensions.

Immediacy: Liking

Arousal: Responsiveness

Dominance: Balance of Power.

### **3 C: Context, Cluster & Change**

✓ **Identifying a liar**

Challenges of Studying Non-Verbal Communication:

Ambiguous, Continuous, Multi-channelled, Culture-based

### **Caution**

Don't jump into conclusions

Consider other external factors like temperature, weather, etc

Appearance can be deceptive

**Awareness can help in controlling negative expressions.**

**Develop wide range of nonverbal behaviours**

➤ **Positive Body Language: Smile, Open Posture, Forward Lean, Touch, Eye Contact, Gestures & Nods**



# Developing Body Language for the Interview

Starts much before the interview!



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# Be Calm and Collected

- When the call comes—
- Don't get nervous or over confident.
- Pride goes before fall.
- Nervousness is natural and positive.
- Fear in control ensures huge success.



The night before the interview, spend some time with a well-wisher, telling her/him why you would be the best for the position.

Before you can possibly convince the interviewer that you are right for the job, you have to believe it yourself.

**Go with that killer instinct!**





# Purpose of the Interview

**Employers are assessing:**

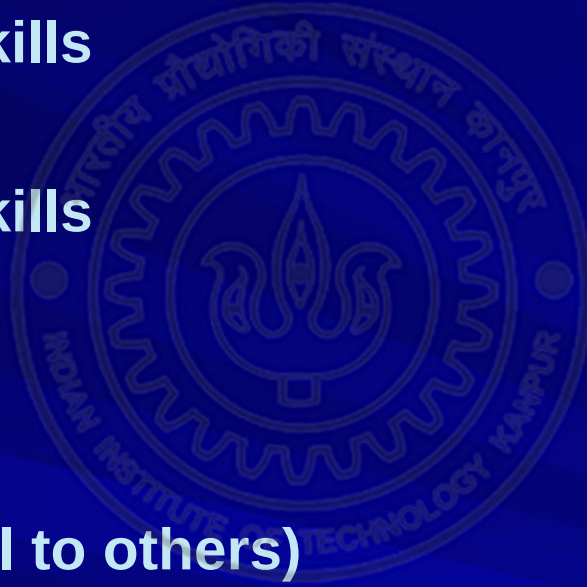
- **Your personality**
- **Communication skills**
- **Your appearance**
- **Your Attitude**
- **If you will fit into the organization**
- **Your strengths and weaknesses**
- **Verifying your resume**





# What are Employers Looking for?

- Strong work ethic (professionalism, commitment, keenness, sincerity, integrity)
- Self-confidence
- Strong communication skills
- Motivation/Initiative
- Evidence of leadership skills
- Organizational skills
- Adaptability/flexibility
- Ability to work in teams
- Interpersonal (relates well to others)
- Time Management skills
- Stress Management Skills
- Meticulousness to details
- Friendliness and accessibility
- Tact and diplomacy
- Conflict Resolution Skills



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# Make a Good First Impression

**First impressions count often for  
far more than is logical!**

The result of the interview will depend largely on the impression you make during the first five minutes.

Your subject, your marks, and your experience got you to the interview but it is the “soft skills” that will take you to the next level.

# Keep in Mind

**1. Punctuality**

**2. Dress**

**3. Handshake**

**4. Body**

**Language**

**5. Enthusiasm**



# Punctuality

**Be there before time.**

**Do whatever it takes  
to arrive half an hour  
before.**

**Late arrival for a job  
interview is never  
excusable.**





## ***Before you arrive***

**If possible, stop by the restroom and make sure that your hair is combed, makeup is fresh, etc...**

## ***When you arrive***

**Smile and say “good morning/afternoon” to anyone that you might meet.**

# ***When you arrive***

**If you are asked to wait:**

**Take a seat and look at a magazine if available.**

**Do not read a newspaper.**

**If offered something to eat or drink, politely decline.**

**Don't stare.**

**Don't wait idly, introduce yourself to other candidates. This would give you a chance to size up your competitors. Later you can use their feedback.**

**Be aware of your body language. There may be a psychologist studying your behaviour!**

# Dress For Interview Success



**Your appearance will speak volumes before you ever utter a word.**

- **Be Well Dressed**
- **Nice Looking & Smiling**
- **Stay conservative & traditional**
- **Dress for the position you want  
NOT the position you have**

# Dress Code for Interviews: The Do's

## Do's

- ✓ **Business-like outfit (the type that reflects your personality, character and values)**
- ✓ **Clean, ironed clothing**
- ✓ **Matching clothes – simple**
- ✓ **Clean, polished, conservative shoes**
- ✓ **Clean, tidy, well-groomed hair style**
- ✓ **Fresh haircut a couple of days before interview**
- ✓ **Clean, trimmed finger nails**
- ✓ **Clean teeth**
- ✓ **Appropriate accessories**
- ✓ **Simple make-up**
- ✓ **Minimal cologne or perfume**

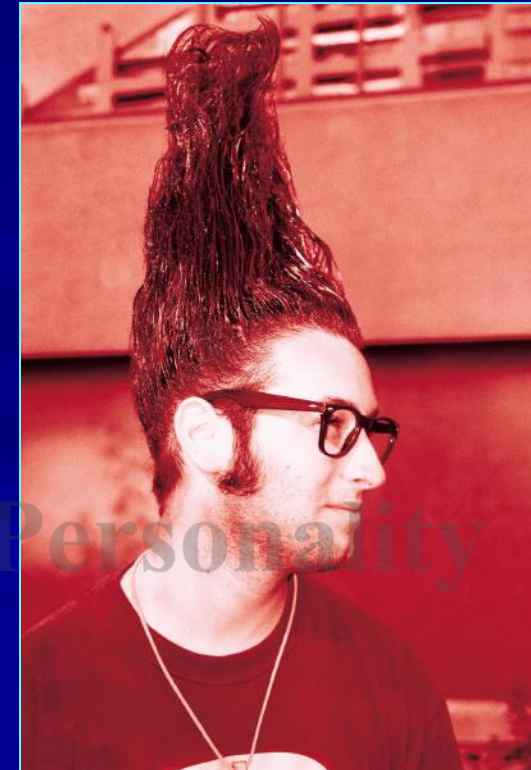




# Dress Code for Interviews: The Don'ts

## Don'ts

- X Runners, jeans, T-shirts
- X Distracting jewellery
- X Strong perfume
- X Strong aftershave
- X Smells of alcohol, garlic, cigarettes
- X Chew gum
- X Punky, weird hairstyle



# Avoid showy displays

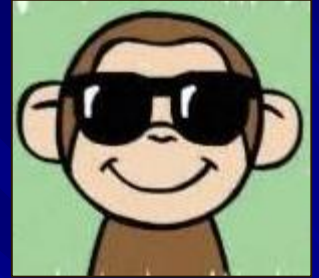
- Avoid nail polish, especially of different colours
- Rings, of different types and colours



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# Avoid Non-Verbal Blockers!

- Wearing sunglasses
- Wearing a cap (with funky captions/colour)
- Wearing complete black or dark dress
- Wearing a new, uncomfortable dress
- Using shopping bags to carry files
- Having a close haircut on the interview day





# ***Keys to Success***

Before you walk in that door, clear your mind.

**Turn off your beeper and cell phone!**

There is nothing at that time more important than that interview.

**Let them know, before you even say your first word that you are the right choice.**

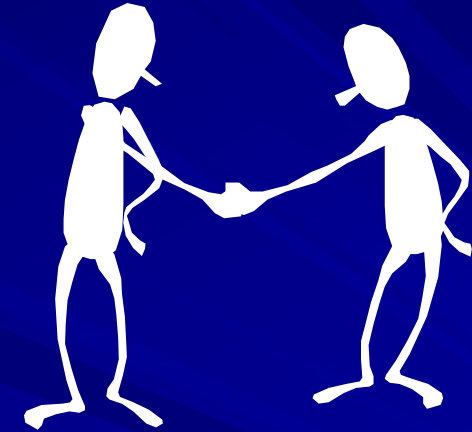
**Radiate Confidence. Smile!**



# Successful Interview

## Body Language: Presenting Yourself

- Establish a good personal contact
  - FRIENDLY
  - PROFESSIONAL
- Be aware of the body language
- Shake hands and don't be afraid of being "only" a student.
- Don't forget to ask permission to sit down.



# Handshake

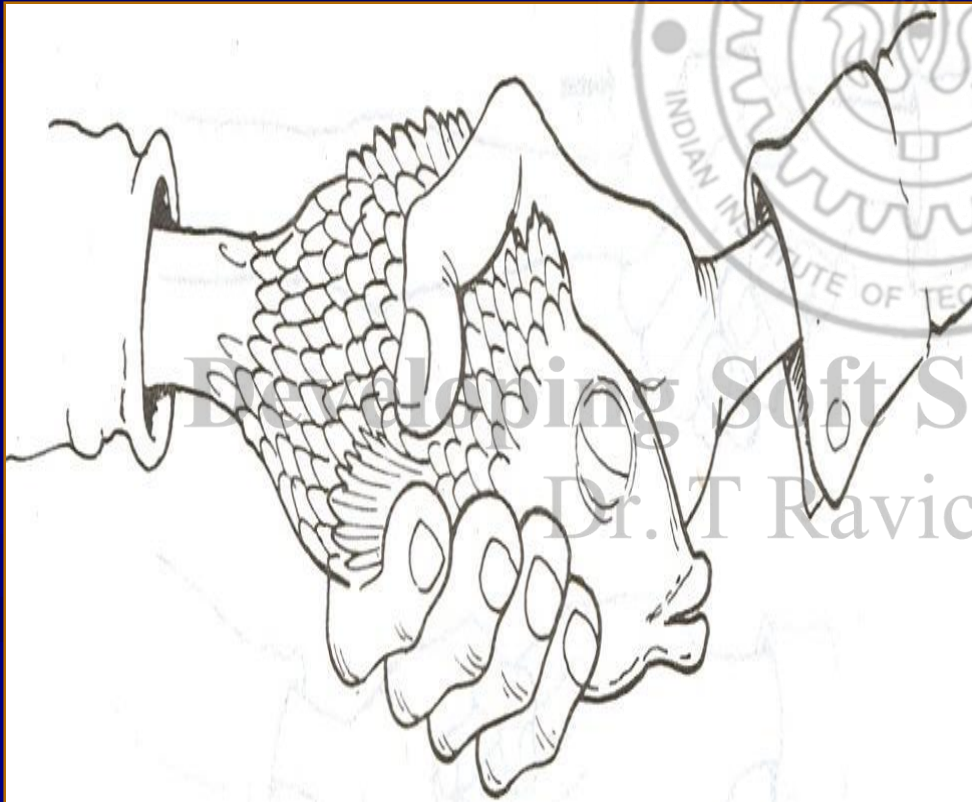
- A firm handshake is appropriate and projects confidence.
- Make eye contact when you shake.



If you have difficulty maintaining eye contact, try this simple technique:

Concentrate on noticing and remembering the colour of the person's eyes as you shake hands.

# Neither the dead fish nor the knuckle grinder...



# But a Firm Handshake!





# Gestures

**Gestures should be very limited during the interview. Use open ones.**

**Avoid the defensive gestures.**

**When you do use gestures, make sure they are natural and meaningful.**

**(Praying Position, Namaste)**



# Success in the first 30 seconds!

- Maintain eye contact
- Occasionally nod your head in agreement
- Smile and show animation
- Lean toward the speaker
- Speak at a moderate rate
- Use an assuring tone



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# How to Make a Good First Impression in an Interview

- **Research the company to find out its values**
- **Clothing often speaks louder than skills, If you do not dress up for the interview you send a message that you are not interested in the job.**

**Find out what type of dress code is enforced and dress appropriately.**

**Companies report that they base 90% of their decision on whether an interviewee is right for the job based on appearance alone.**

**Many employers decide within the first 30 seconds if an applicant will fit into their company based on looks.**

# Enthusiasm and Eye Contact

**Show your enthusiasm by making eye contact and keeping an interested expression.**

**If embarrassed to maintain direct eye contact, focus on the nose or the forehead**



# Posture

**Posture sends out a signal  
of your confidence and  
power potential.**



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**Stand tall, walk tall and most of all, sit tall.**

# Pre-interview Quick Check List

- Appropriate Dressing
- Maintenance of good posture (from walking to sitting)
- Smile radiating confidence
- Firm handshake
- Cool and calm behaviour
- Maintaining eye contact
- Using a loud enough voice, and speaking clearly
- Knowing when to stop
- Leaving a pleasant feeling at the end

# During the Interview



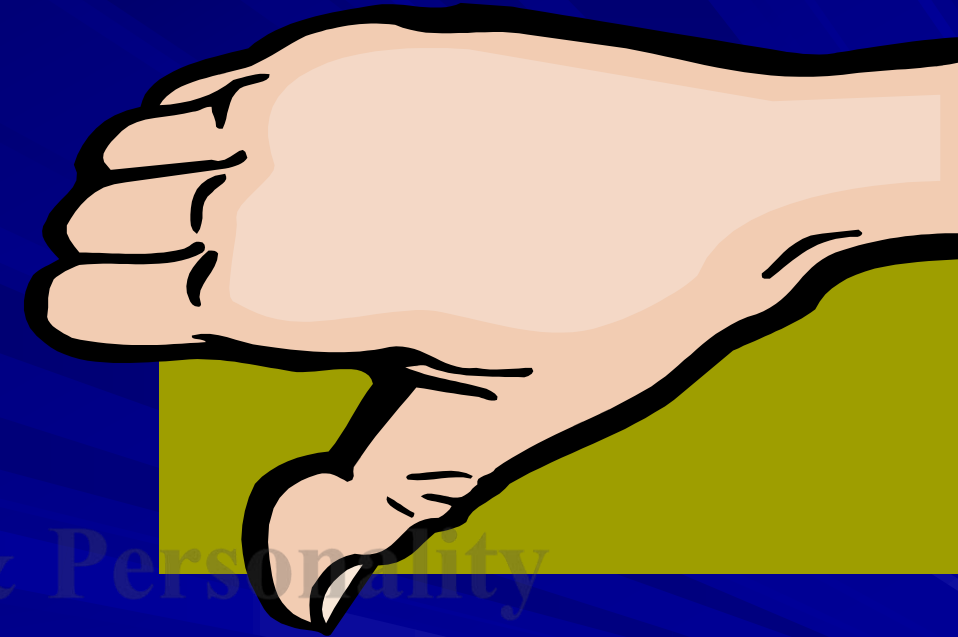
- Take permission to enter
- Greet Everyone in the room
- Take permission to sit, pull the chair gently
- Don't lean back; slightly bend forward
- Make Eye-Contact
- Give a firm handshake
- Be Polite – Smile
- Be Self Confident throughout
- Mirror their good body language

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# During the Interview

## DON'TS

- DON'T Chew Gum
- DON'T Smoke
- DON'T make distractions
- DON'T slouch
- DON'T ramble
- DON'T wear too much perfume/cologne
- Don't use file/bag for defence
- Don't take coffee/drink even if offered freely





# The Close

**Before you leave:**

**Make eye contact, smile, thank you.**

**Firm handshake or Namaste**

**Leave confidently; don't fumble or let things fall from your hands!**

**Leave with the same enthusiasm with which you started  
(even if the interview didn't go well)**



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When you go to an interview  
with the right frame of mind and  
with the right body language,  
you will get the right job  
at the right time!



**SUCCESS**

# Developing Soft Skills and Personality



**Week 7**  
**Module 6**  
**Lecture 42**

**Body  
Language**

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**For Group Discussions**

# Highlights



## Highlights of the Last Lecture



### **Body Language for Interviews:**

Preparation at mental, emotional and spiritual levels is required much before the interview to remain calm and confident.

**Employers are clearly looking for soft skills which comprise many body language traits such as**

✓ **Appearance, attitude, personality & positive outlook.**

In order to make the first best impression, one has to keep in mind:

**Punctuality, Dress, Handshake, Body Language, Enthusiasm**

### **Do's and Don'ts**

**Dress Code**

**Appearance & use of accessories**

**Emphasised on firm handshake, eye contact, appropriate posture, showing enthusiasm throughout, smiling radiating confidence, remaining calm and collected, leaving with a good feeling.**



**Body Language of interview is similar to the**

**Body Language of Group Discussion**

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# WHY GROUP DISCUSSION?

- ❑ Easy way to evaluate and eliminate several candidates simultaneously.
- ❑ Time-plus-cost effective method.
- ❑ The best way to identify a natural leader!

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# WHAT IS GROUP DISCUSSION?

- A group interactive selection process which the employers use to gauge certain personality traits of prospective candidates

*Some Expected Personality Traits are—*

- ✓ **Leadership Skills**
- ✓ **Group Management /Team Working Skills**
- ✓ **Communication Skills**
- ✓ **Adaptability and flexibility**
- ✓ **Positive mental outlook**
- ✓ **Decent and professional dressing/grooming sense**
- ✓ **Assertive Body Language**
- ✓ **Projection of a distinctively likeable personality**
- ✓ **Reasoning ability**
- ✓ **Analytical ability**
- ✓ **Logical and coherent thinking**



# WHAT IS GROUP DISCUSSION?

Elicits the views of all participants & evolves a consensus through active and intense interaction

- ✓ Group -- NOT individual discussion!
- ✓ Discussion-- NOT Public Speaking, Debate or Interview
- ✓ Public Speaking → the audience judges a speaker without competing with him
- ✓ Debate → a moderator/chairperson presides, giving it a proper shape and direction
- ✓ Interview → a panel evaluates the candidate's suitability for the concerned job





# STRUCTURE OF A GD



- ❑ **An unstructured activity**
- ❑ **A leaderless group**
- ❑ **All the candidates are competitors**
- ❑ **Expected to join the discussion without the presence and participation of the examiner**
- ❑ **10 to 50 candidates;**
- ❑ **15 to 30 minutes**

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# GD IS ALL ABOUT . . .

---



❖ **Co-ordination**  
and

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❖ **Co-operation**



# GD IS ALL ABOUT . . .

---

## Co-ordination



- ❑ Leadership qualities
- ❑ Management skills
- ❑ Planning (time, procedure)
- ❑ Conflict-resolution skills/  
harmonization



# GD IS ALL ABOUT . . .



## Co-operation

- ❑ Working together towards a shared aim
  - ❑ Doing the things that you hate to do . . .
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and doing that with a smile!





# BASIC COMPONENTS OF A GD



## ❖ 4 Basic Components:

1. **Leadership** [initiative, decision-making, planning, vision]
2. **Knowledge** [subject, current affairs, technical advancements]
3. **Communication Skills** [active listening, fluency, clarity, coherence, diction, enunciation, effectiveness]
4. **Personality Manifestation** [Soft skills, body language, positive outlook, pleasing mannerism]

# EVALUATION CRITERIA

| <i>Personality</i><br>25                 | <i>Knowledge</i><br>25           | <i>Communication Skills</i><br>25 | <i>Leadership</i><br>25                               |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Dress/<br/>Appearance</b>             | <b>Depth</b>                     | <b>Active<br/>Listening</b>       | <b>Initiative</b>                                     |
| <b>Temperament/<br/>Tone &amp; Voice</b> | <b>Range</b>                     | <b>Fluency</b>                    | <b>Team Spirit</b>                                    |
| <b>Gesture/<br/>Body Language</b>        | <b>Logical<br/>Thinking</b>      | <b>Diction</b>                    | <b>Endurance/<br/>Conflict-<br/>resolution skills</b> |
| <b>Mental State</b>                      | <b>Organization of<br/>Ideas</b> | <b>Enunciation</b>                | <b>Decision-Making</b>                                |
| <b>Over-all<br/>impression</b>           | <b>Over-all<br/>impression</b>   | <b>Over-all<br/>impression</b>    | <b>Over-all<br/>impression</b>                        |

# POSITIVE TRAITS

| <i>Personality</i>             | <i>Knowledge</i>                     | <i>Communication Skills</i>       | <i>Leadership</i>                                  |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
|                                |                                      |                                   |                                                    |
| <b>Enthusiasm</b>              | <b>Depth</b>                         | <b>Clarity</b>                    | <b>Initiative</b>                                  |
| <b>Keenness,<br/>Curiosity</b> | <b>Range</b>                         | <b>Felicity of<br/>expression</b> | <b>Team Spirit</b>                                 |
| <b>Participation</b>           | <b>Analytical Ability</b>            | <b>Categorical<br/>conclusion</b> | <b>Flexibility,<br/>Conflict-resolution skills</b> |
| <b>Cheerfulness</b>            | <b>Organization of<br/>Ideas</b>     | <b>Coherence of<br/>ideas</b>     | <b>Decision-Making</b>                             |
| <b>Smartness</b>               | <b>Co-ordination of<br/>thoughts</b> | <b>Effectiveness</b>              | <b>Patience</b>                                    |

# NEGATIVE TRAITS

| <i>Personality</i>                        | <i>Knowledge</i>                   | <i>Communication Skills</i>   | <i>Leadership</i>                |
|-------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Introversion, slowness</b>             | <b>Lack of subject knowledge</b>   | <b>Fumbling, Muteness</b>     | <b>Isolated, Insulated</b>       |
| <b>Lack of confidence</b>                 | <b>Lack of meticulousness</b>      | <b>Confused &amp; unclear</b> | <b>Unapproachable</b>            |
| <b>Apprehensive, tenseness</b>            | <b>Poor quality of mind</b>        | <b>Meandering</b>             | <b>Egoistic &amp; Aggressive</b> |
| <b>Impoliteness</b>                       | <b>Lack of creative ideas</b>      | <b>Incoherence</b>            | <b>Weak &amp; Wavering</b>       |
| <b>Apathy, unresponsive-ness, boredom</b> | <b>Lack of analytical thinking</b> | <b>Monotony</b>               | <b>Impatient</b>                 |



# THE BEST POSSIBLE ATTITUDE!

*You are right . . .*

*But –*

*I am not wrong!*

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Promoting a win-win situation!

# MOST COMMON BODY LANGUAGE PITFALLS

---

- ✗ Anxious to talk too much
- ✗ Nervous and talks little
- ✗ Aggressive behaviour
- ✗ Arrogant gestures
- ✗ Distractive body language
- ✗ Indifference; spectator behavior
- ✗ Fidgeting
- ✗ Smelling bad

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# SOME PRACTICAL TIPS

- ❖ Maintain eye contact throughout the GD
- ❖ Avoid distractive and negative body language:
  - Biting nails, shaking legs,
  - Picking nose, playing with pen
- ❖ Do not lean back in chair with hands clasped behind head (indicates arrogance/disinterest)
- ✗ Don't be aggressive, be assertive!



# Body Language in Group discussions

Posture: Walk upright  
Give firm handshake  
Control aggressive behaviour  
Lean slightly forward to show interest and empathy  
Use open gestures  
Avoid hiding behind file or handbag  
Nod your head to show agreement





# SOME PRACTICAL TIPS

- ❖ Give that radiating smile
- ❖ Be cheerful
- ❖ Monitor your performance using feedback from friends or from own video recording
- ❖ Do not wait to change your personality once you get a particular job; assume the personality even before!
- ❖ Go with the winning attitude!

**REMEMBER . . .**

**The aim of argument,  
or of discussion,  
should not be victory,  
but progress.**

**~Joseph Joubert**

